3.4 Function Notation

Name _____ Period ____ Date _____

Algebra I 3.4 (30-minute plan) · Student sheet

I can…

- evaluate functions using function notation.
- find the input that gives a certain output.
- graph linear functions and interpret function notation in real life.

Vocabulary · fill in the missing word

Function notation — f(x), read "f of x," is the _____ of function f for the input x

f(a) = b — the point (a, b) is on the _____ of f

Part 1 · Notes and examples (fill in each note, then work the example)

Function notation: f(x) is read "_____."

Evaluating: To evaluate f(3), _____ 3 for x.

Example 1

Let f(x) = −4x + 7. Find f(2) and f(−3).

Solving: To find x when f(x) = 15, set the rule equal to 15 and _____.

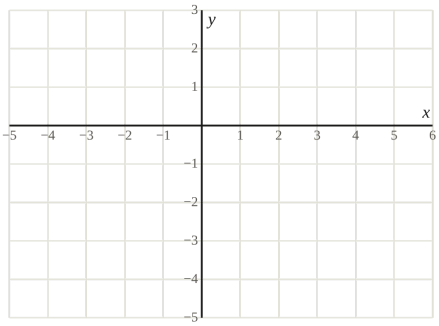
Example 2

Let g(x) = 5x − 3. Find x so that g(x) = 22.

On the graph: f(3) = 11 means the point _____ is on the graph.

Example 3

Graph $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x - 2$. Use the graph to find $f(4)$ and the x-value where $f(x) = -3$.



Part 2 · Partner practice

Partner practice

Let $h(x) = x^2 + 1$. Find $h(-3)$.